

NEWS BRIEFING

GOLD ON NEWS TIME

How gold moves when the big releases land, and why trying to trap that move rarely works.

Five diagrams, one decision tree, all times Malaysian.

THE IMPACT LADDER

Not every release carries the same weight for gold. The economic calendar colour-codes impact; what matters for XAUUSD is the data that moves the dollar and US interest rates. This is the order.

HIGH IMPACT

***CPI - NFP
FOMC***

Inflation, employment data and interest-rate decisions. Gold can move hundreds of pips in minutes, in both directions, before it settles. This is the window we close completely.

MEDIUM IMPACT

***PPI - PCE
GDP***

Moves gold when the number lands far from expectations. Usually it reinforces the direction already in place rather than creating a new one.

CANNOT BE SCHEDULED

***GEOPOLITICS
RISK-OFF***

No fixed release time. Gold is often the place people shelter, so the move can be large and arrive without notice. It cannot be planned for — only managed through position size.

NOTE

Other currencies' news — AUD, NZD, GBP — barely touches XAUUSD. If your instrument is gold, your calendar is the US calendar.

Gold moves hardest when London and New York are open together. US data lands squarely inside that window — which is why one hour at night matters more than eight hours in the morning.



London and New York
overlap. The largest moves,
and nearly all of the US data.

ONE EXPENSIVE HOUR

This is what happens around a high-impact release. Note that trading costs rise **before** price moves — you pay the most at exactly the moment you most want to be in.



FIGURE 3 • SCHEMATIC. THE SHAPE SHOWN, NOT REAL PRICE DATA.

T-5

The spread starts widening. Liquidity is pulled out.

T

The spike. Price can jump straight past your level without stopping.

T+5

The first direction is often taken back. Long wicks form.

T+15 • T+30

The spread narrows and a new structure starts to show.

WHY TRAPPING GOLD RARELY WORKS

The two-sided trap looks clean on paper: place orders above and below price before the release, let the market pick a direction, collect. On gold, four things happen and the idea falls apart.

ONE

Both sides get filled

The first spike takes the level above; the pullback takes the one below. You are holding two losses, not one profit.

TWO

You are not filled where you placed it

At the release, price jumps. Slippage makes your stop distance wider than planned, and your 1% risk is no longer 1%.

THREE

The spread is at its widest right then

Gold is already expensive to trade next to the major currency pairs. Between T-5 and T+5 that cost doubles.

FOUR

The first decision is often wrong

A good number does not mean gold falls. The market weighs several data points at once, and the real direction is sometimes only clear an hour later.

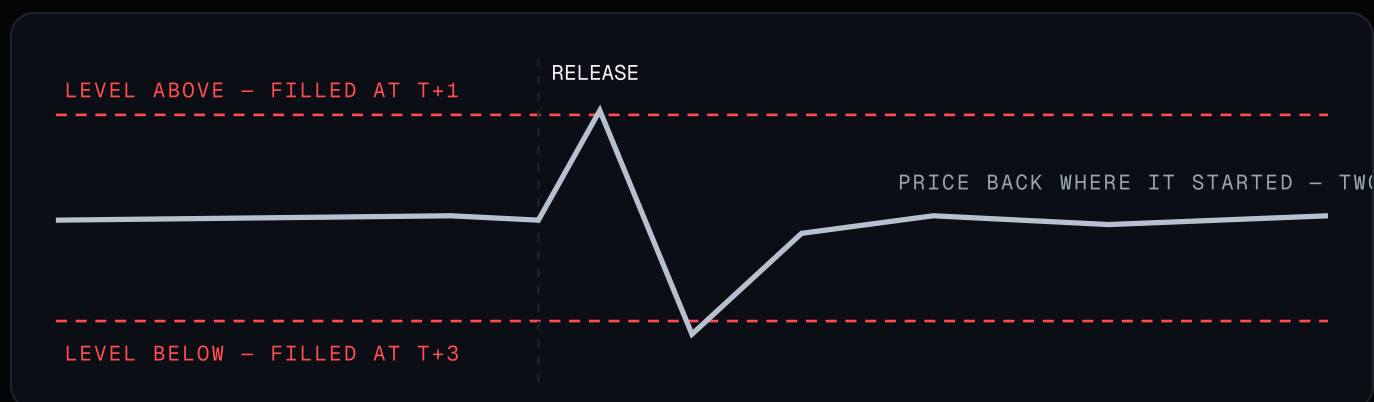


FIGURE 4 · SCHEMATIC OF THE SPIKE SHAPE, NOT REAL PRICE DATA.

TRADE, WAIT, OR STAND ASIDE

Three questions, answered before the release and not after it. Any one of them can end the sequence — and standing aside is a legitimate decision, not a failure.

01 Is this release high impact for gold?

NO

Trade your normal daily plan as usual.

YES

Continue to question two.

02 Do you have a position open going into T-15?

YES

Reduce the size or close it. Move the stop to breakeven if it is already in profit.

NO

Do not open a new position. Wait.

03 After T+30, is the structure clear?

YES

A level broke and was retested, and the spread has narrowed. Enter on the plan, at normal risk.

NO

Stand aside until the next session. Nothing has been lost.

The move after the news runs longer than the first spike. Whoever waits thirty minutes misses nothing.

THE MONTHLY RHYTHM

The gold calendar repeats each month in roughly the same order. Once you know the rhythm you never have to be surprised — you only have to confirm the exact dates on the economic calendar.

W1

WEEK ONE

Employment · NFP

The first Friday of every month. One of the most violent windows for gold all month.

W2

WEEK TWO

Inflation · CPI, then PPI

Usually around mid-month. Inflation moves rate expectations, and rate expectations move gold.

W3

WEEK THREE

FOMC, in meeting months

Eight times a year, so not every month. The rate decision and the committee's projections land together, followed by the press conference.

W4

WEEK FOUR

PCE, and GDP in quarter months

The Federal Reserve's preferred inflation measure closes the month. GDP arrives quarterly, with revisions after it.

WHAT IS NOT ON THE CALENDAR

Geopolitical news and shelter flows do not wait for a schedule. They cannot be planned for — only managed with a position size you can carry at any moment.

FIVE LINES

- 01 For gold, the calendar that matters is the US calendar: CPI, NFP, FOMC, then PPI, PCE and GDP.
- 02 The largest moves happen at night, when London and New York overlap.
- 03 Trading costs peak before price moves. You pay the most at the moment things are least clear.
- 04 The two-sided trap on gold usually opens both sides. That is not a strategy, it is two losses.
- 05 Wait thirty minutes. Trade the structure that is left, not the first spike.

THE CHANNEL

Gold setups with news windows closed, published with the losses.

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